Ogbonna Arinze

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SUMMARY

Senior Frontend Engineer with 8 years building **React** and **TypeScript** SaaS interfaces, including real-time chat surfaces, streaming dashboards, and inbox-style workflows. Deep experience with state management (**Redux**, **React Query**, **Zustand**), real-time integration via **SSE** and **EventSource**, and full testing pipelines with **Jest**, **Playwright**, and **Cypress**. Fully distributed since 2020 across San Francisco, Lagos, Beijing, and Berlin teams, with strong async written communication. Has shipped a streaming AI chat widget at Genentech and an SSE-powered conversational platform at OurNigeria.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Core Stack:** React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ESNext), Next.js, modern CSS, HTML, responsive layouts.
- **State Management:** Redux, Redux Toolkit, React Query, Zustand, Jotai, Context API patterns.
- **Real-time and Communications:** SSE streaming with keepalive heartbeats, native EventSource API, REST APIs, webhook-driven flows, JWT auth.
- **Testing:** Playwright (E2E in CI with Allure reporting), Jest, Enzyme, Cypress, Storybook component documentation.
- **Cloud-native:** Docker / Docker Compose, AWS (CloudFront, S3), Vercel, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Heroku.
- **Performance:** Lighthouse, Core Web Vitals, code splitting, lazy loading, React Profiler, bundle analysis.
- **Async Collaboration:** 8 years remote-first with EMEA and Americas teams, written-first specs and reviews.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Genentech (Roche) San Francisco, CA (Remote)
Frontend Engineer *May 2023 - Present*

- Co-developed a full-stack **Next.js** chat widget powered by a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) system using OpenAI GPT models, LangChain, Vercel AI SDK, and Chroma vector database, enabling real-time conversational queries against connected user data sources, with the widget embeddable on external sites.
- Spearheaded the redesign of the main clinical trial data product, migrating from a **Vue.js** web application to a **React** Chrome extension with **TypeScript**, owning the rebuild end-to-end.
- Implemented **JWT-based authentication** and role-based access control on the frontend with HTTP-only cookies, protected client-side routes, permission-gated UI, and seamless token refresh.
- Introduced **Redux** for client state and **React Query** for server-state caching, request deduplication, and background refetching, refactoring class components to functional components.
- Integrated **Playwright** end-to-end tests into the **GitHub Actions** CI/CD pipeline, published **Allure Reports** on GitHub Pages, and pushed Slack notifications with deep links to test results on every push.
- Optimized application performance through lazy loading, code splitting, image optimization, memoization, and CDN delivery, profiled with **Lighthouse** and Chrome DevTools.
- Architected a reusable design system in **React** and **Radix UI** with **Tailwind CSS**, raising UI consistency, accessibility (WCAG/ARIA), and developer velocity.
- Maintained the existing **Vue.js** codebase in parallel with the React rebuild, fixing bugs and shipping features without regression.
- Mentored two junior developers (interns) through written-first reviews and pair programming.

Descasio Lagos, Nigeria (Hybrid)
Senior Frontend Developer *May 2021 - Mar 2023*

- Led the design and implementation of a greenfield **React** + **TypeScript** cloud console interface, achieving a **25% boost in user engagement** and accelerating delivery by **30%**.
- Profiled render bottlenecks with **React Profiler** and **Lighthouse**, cut bundle size **30-40%**, achieving a **35% faster** initial load.
- Drove a **40% improvement** in runtime performance by reworking caching strategies across the React application.
- Introduced **Jest** and **Enzyme** testing frameworks plus **Storybook** for component documentation, leading to a **20% drop** in bug reports.
- Established team engineering standards via **ESLint**, **Prettier**, **Husky**, **Lint-staged**, and **GitHub Actions**, reducing errors and accelerating CI/CD.
- Mentored junior engineers on frontend best practices.

ActivEdge Technologies Lagos, Nigeria
Senior React Developer *Oct 2019 - Sep 2021*

- Adopted the native **EventSource API** for real-time data streaming in place of socket.io, improving latency and reducing dependency surface across messaging-style settlement views.

- Built a high-volume bank Settlement Solution in a team of 3, handling thousands to millions of transactions daily and boosting settlement rates by **80%**.
- Developed payment modules (MasterCard, VISA, Express-cash, E-commerce) with **React**, **Redux**, **RxJS** for streamed data flows, and **Axios** for asynchronous APIs.
- Built a real-time account reconciliation tool, lifting daily reconciliation by **60%**.
- Built dynamic data visualization dashboards with **react-chartjs**, **Redux Toolkit**, and **Ant Design**.

Founders Lair Beijing, China (Remote)
Full Stack Engineer (Contract) *Oct 2020 - Feb 2021*

- Translated business requirements into efficient **MongoDB** schemas and developed **NodeJS** RESTful APIs.
- Converted user journeys and Figma designs into reusable **React** components for a consistent UI.
- Engineered a CI/CD pipeline for automated API deployment to Heroku and AWS production servers.
- Mentored two interns through frontend and backend project work.

SureTrade Business Solutions Nigeria
Frontend Developer *Mar 2018 - Oct 2019*

- Built **SureEdu**, a school management portal, in a team of 5: staff payroll/attendance, student records, guardian portals.
- Designed **MongoDB** schemas and implemented server-side **NodeJS** logic with REST endpoints.
- Authored use cases, translated them into database models, and wrote feature documentation per application.

PROJECTS

OurNigeria ournigeria.ng
Senior Engineer *Feb 2026 - Present*

AI-powered Nigerian budget transparency platform with real-time conversational chat over 700+ documents and 708K+ vector embeddings.

- Implemented **SSE streaming** for real-time chat responses with keepalive heartbeats every 15s to prevent reverse-proxy timeouts, token-budgeted context (summary + recent messages + user profile), and conversation summarization.
- Built a **Telegram bot** with webhook-based message handling, OTP and Telegram OAuth login with 6-digit codes and session cookies, and shareable public conversation pages with SSR.
- Built three **Next.js** apps (citizen-facing chat, admin dashboard, marketing landing) with **React 19**, **TypeScript**, **Tailwind CSS v4**, and 22 inline chart types in an **Nx** + **pnpm** monorepo.
- Configured CI/CD with **GitHub Actions**, **Playwright** E2E across 4 projects (web auth, dashboard auth, desktop, mobile), and **Docker Compose** production deployment with health checks.

EDUCATION

University of Nigeria Nsukka, Enugu
BSc Computer Science - 4.1 CGPA *Graduation Date: Sep 2019*